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Register a political party

Listen

This page explains the steps to register a political party. We assess applications for registration under the Electoral Act 2002 (Vic).

To register a party, please read the information on this page. If you would like a briefing from us about the registration process and application requirements, please contact us at rppregistration@vec.vic.gov.au (mailto:rppregistration@vec.vic.gov.au).

2026 state election

The deadline to apply to register a political party for the 2026 state election is currently Friday 31 July 2026.

We cannot accept new applications or register any new political parties between the day the writ is issued and the day it is returned. We will pause any applications in progress when the writ is issued until after the election.

A bill has been introduced to Parliament to change the deadline to apply to register a new political party. If this bill is passed, **the deadline to register a new political party for the 2026 state election will be 1 June 2026**. Please consider this proposed change when preparing a new application.

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Benefits of registration

A registered political party:

- can have its name printed on ballot papers next to its candidates
- can nominate all candidates and register how-to-vote cards through a central process, instead of with an individual election manager
- can register its logo
- can receive public funding
- can access enrolment information for permitted uses. This does not include phone numbers or email address.

An unregistered party can still participate at elections but without these benefits.

How to register a party

You must apply in writing and include:

- the name and address of the proposed registered officer. The registered officer manages the party's administration and is our main contact during the registration process
- a copy of the party's constitution

- a statutory declaration confirming the number of eligible members
- a list of at least 500 eligible members, inlcuding names and enrolled addresses
- an application fee of $840.50 (50 fee units at 1 July 2025).

Please read the ***Applicants handbook*** for the full party registration instructions. The full application checklist is in Appendix A of the *Applicants handbook*.

A party must show it has at least 500 eligible members. An eligible member is a person who is:

- enrolled to vote in Victoria
- a member of the proposed party according to any party rules
- not a member of any other registered political party.

Each party must make sure its member list is correct and current. We do not fix incorrect member information.

Logo registration

Registering a logo is optional. To register a party logo you must:

1. complete a logo application form
2. send us the form with electronic copies of the logo.

Logo specifications are in Appendix D of the ***Applicants handbook***.

Our assessment process

It can take a few months to assess your application. You can help by:

- providing accurate and complete documents
- encouraing your members to complete and return their response forms as soon as possible (step 3 below).

Step 1: application

Send your application for party registration and supporting documents to us.

We'll check all documents are valid and complete.

We may contact you if your documents are incomplete or need to be updated.

Step 2: consultation stage

We advertise valid applications in the *Victoria Government Gazette*, our website and through media releases. Members of the public can submit objections on applications.

Step 3: member verification

We contact people on the member list you provide and ask them to complete a form saying they are eligible members.

We must confirm the party has at least **500 eligible members** and that the application meets all legislative requirements before registering it.

This step can sometimes take many months. You can help us with verification by reminding your members to complete this form.

Step 4: registration outcome

If we decide the party must be registered, we will:

- notify you of the outcome
- publish a notice in the *Victorian Government Gazette* and send a media release about the party's registration
- notify anyone who objected to your application

- update the register of political parties (/candidates-and-parties/registered-political-parties/currently-registered-parties) to include the party

If we decide a party must not be registered, we will notify you. You will not be able to reapply for **6 months**.

Review of decisions

The Victorian Civil and Administrative Tribunal (VCAT) can review our decision to:

- register a party
- not register a party

You can apply to VCAT for a review within **28 days** of our decision.

VCAT cannot review decisions between the day the writ is issued and the day it is returned.

Information for party members

Political parties share the personal information of their members so we can check each person is an eligible member.

We handle all personal information in line with the *Privacy and Data Protection Act 2014* (Vic).

We do not share any individual responses we receive during the verification step with political parties. For more information, please visit our privacy page (/privacy).

If you need to confirm your membership status, please contact the political party.

More information

For more information about the registration process, see our handbook or contact us at rppregistration@vec.vic.gov.au (mailto:rppregistration@vec.vic.gov.au).

Registration of political parties handbook

Download the *Applicants handbook* for detailed registration instructions, application forms, checklists and more.

- Registration of political parties handbook (PDF, 412KB) (/-/media/5e541322da6a43e5a7a0ea1b2c57371a.pdf)
- Registration of political parties handbook (Word, 4.4 MB) (/-/media/98e4b703d7cb4b7b885c48be9cc1bfe0.docx)

Nepean District by-election

We cannot process any new political party applications or make updates to existing registered political parties during a state by-election.

The writ for the Nepean District by-election will soon be issued by the Speaker of the Legislative Assembly. We'll process any applications lodged during this by-election immediately after the writ is returned. We'll also resume processing existing applications after this date.

Contact us (/contact-us)

Connect with us

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The Victorian Electoral Commission acknowledges and pays respect to the Traditional Owners of the land.

Privacy (/privacy) Legal (/legal)

Sitemap (/sitemap) Accessibility (/accessibility)

Authorised by S. Bluemmel, Electoral Commissioner, 530 Collins Street, Melbourne, Victoria